Zachary Godfrey

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Senior Software Engineer with 13+ years of experience building and modernizing web applications, high-throughput APIs, and data processing systems. Backend-focused engineer with hands-on experience optimizing search performance, designing parallel data pipelines, and modernizing applications through cloud migration.

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, PHP, HTML, CSS
Backend: Node.js, GraphQL, NestJS, Hapi
Frontend: React, Next.js, Angular
Cloud & Messaging: AWS (Lambda, Step Functions, S3, GovCloud), RabbitMQ
Data & Search: Elasticsearch, OpenSearch, PostgreSQL, SQL Server
DevOps Tools: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, New Relic, PagerDuty

Senior Software Engineer
Aug 2021 - Oct 2026, The Knot Worldwide

- Developed features, troubleshot production issues, and optimized OpenSearch queries for a customer-facing marketplace's GraphQL API, handling 9M+ requests per day with an average response time of 60 milliseconds.
- Maintained and enhanced an asynchronous data pipeline that synchronizes data updates from multiple systems into OpenSearch using RabbitMQ.
- Collaborated across Product, Design, Data, QA, and DevOps while developing features in a shared codebase with 50+ regular contributors across multiple development teams.
- Interviewed engineering candidates and onboarded new engineers.

Senior Software Engineer
Oct 2018 - Jul 2021, BAM Technologies

- Modernized a government web application by replacing its C# and Microsoft SQL Server stack with Node.js, TypeScript, Angular, and PostgreSQL, reducing vendor lock-in and migrating the application from a military datacenter to AWS GovCloud.
- Owned the architecture, development, and deployment of a redesigned ETL pipeline processing data from 200+ heterogeneous sources, reducing processing time from over 8 hours to under 12 minutes using AWS Lambda, Step Functions, S3, and parallel processing.
- Reduced query times on the application’s primary search endpoint from over 30 seconds to under 500 milliseconds by migrating search data from Microsoft SQL Server to Elasticsearch.
- Conducted meetings with government stakeholders to regularly demonstrate new features, gather feedback, and propose future changes.

Application Developer
Oct 2017 - Oct 2018, Oyova Software

- Designed, developed, and tested new features and bug fixes for clients' websites.
- Communicated directly with clients daily via email and phone to gather requirements, discuss project timelines, and provide status updates.

Application Developer
Nov 2013 - Oct 2017, MECLABS

- Developed and maintained an internal web application that replaced manual spreadsheets, standardized data collection, and enabled new data insights.
- Led training workshops for 50+ employees to support adoption of the web application and transition away from legacy workflows.
- Communicated regularly with stakeholders to gather requirements and demonstrate new functionality.

Quality Assurance Specialist
Jan 2013 - Nov 2013, MECLABS

- Performed manual user-acceptance testing of web applications.
- Built an automated regression testing suite using Java, Selenium, and WebDriver.